SACTCHECK · TREATMENT PASSPORT

# Pembrolizumab every 6 weeks for head and neck cancer

## A record of what you experience

One cycle per page. Each medicine has its own symptom table. Mark the worst symptoms since your last review, when they occurred and what they stopped you doing. Overlapping symptoms can be recorded under more than one medicine; you do not have to identify the cause.

These are patient-language severity prompts, not a validated questionnaire or a formal Common Terminology Criteria for Adverse Events (CTCAE) grading tool. Your team assigns the clinical grade. Serious symptoms override the columns: call without waiting to decide a severity level.

Pembrolizumab 400 mg is given through a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 6 weeks. The whole visit includes safety checks, preparation and observation. Treatment continues until progression or unacceptable toxicity. After 24 months of sustained response without progression, the team may consider stopping; stopping at 24 months is not automatic.

The four pages are reusable recording sheets, not a prescribed four-cycle course. Ask for additional sheets as needed.

**Emergency: 112 / 999.** Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

**Contact oncology immediately** for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

**Insert numbers here**

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

**Insert numbers here**

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

**Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED**

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Your own hospital / contact instructions:

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00558/head_neck/

Full patient information, sources and visual timeline. No identifiers are encoded.

Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

# Pembrolizumab every 6 weeks for head and neck cancer

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

Use one record per received cycle or review; keep held doses and symptoms visible.

**Pembrolizumab head and neck · review record 1** · copy this sheet for another cycle of the same phase.

### Pembrolizumab · Immunotherapy

| Symptom | None | Mild | Moderate / call | Severe / urgent | Emergency signs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Breathing / cough** | ☐ Usual breathing | ☐ New cough or breathlessness: call promptly | ☐ Symptoms with usual activity: urgent review | ☐ Breathless at rest: urgent assessment | ☐ Severe breathing difficulty / collapse: 112/999 |
| **Diarrhoea** | ☐ Usual pattern | ☐ Up to 3 extra stools above normal | ☐ 4–6 extra stools/day or at night: call | ☐ 7+ extra stools/day or dehydration: urgent review | ☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999 |
| **Skin / nail changes** | ☐ None | ☐ Mild change: report | ☐ Pain or daily tasks affected: call | ☐ Spreading infection or blistering: urgent review | ☐ Severe illness / collapse: emergency help |
| **Fatigue** | ☐ Usual energy | ☐ Tiredness improves with rest | ☐ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call | ☐ Self-care difficult: urgent review | ☐ Collapse: 112/999 |

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.

# Pembrolizumab every 6 weeks for head and neck cancer

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

Use one record per received cycle or review; keep held doses and symptoms visible.

**Pembrolizumab head and neck · review record 2** · copy this sheet for another cycle of the same phase.

### Pembrolizumab · Immunotherapy

| Symptom | None | Mild | Moderate / call | Severe / urgent | Emergency signs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Breathing / cough** | ☐ Usual breathing | ☐ New cough or breathlessness: call promptly | ☐ Symptoms with usual activity: urgent review | ☐ Breathless at rest: urgent assessment | ☐ Severe breathing difficulty / collapse: 112/999 |
| **Diarrhoea** | ☐ Usual pattern | ☐ Up to 3 extra stools above normal | ☐ 4–6 extra stools/day or at night: call | ☐ 7+ extra stools/day or dehydration: urgent review | ☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999 |
| **Skin / nail changes** | ☐ None | ☐ Mild change: report | ☐ Pain or daily tasks affected: call | ☐ Spreading infection or blistering: urgent review | ☐ Severe illness / collapse: emergency help |
| **Fatigue** | ☐ Usual energy | ☐ Tiredness improves with rest | ☐ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call | ☐ Self-care difficult: urgent review | ☐ Collapse: 112/999 |

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.

# Pembrolizumab every 6 weeks for head and neck cancer

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

Use one record per received cycle or review; keep held doses and symptoms visible.

**Pembrolizumab head and neck · review record 3** · copy this sheet for another cycle of the same phase.

### Pembrolizumab · Immunotherapy

| Symptom | None | Mild | Moderate / call | Severe / urgent | Emergency signs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Breathing / cough** | ☐ Usual breathing | ☐ New cough or breathlessness: call promptly | ☐ Symptoms with usual activity: urgent review | ☐ Breathless at rest: urgent assessment | ☐ Severe breathing difficulty / collapse: 112/999 |
| **Diarrhoea** | ☐ Usual pattern | ☐ Up to 3 extra stools above normal | ☐ 4–6 extra stools/day or at night: call | ☐ 7+ extra stools/day or dehydration: urgent review | ☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999 |
| **Skin / nail changes** | ☐ None | ☐ Mild change: report | ☐ Pain or daily tasks affected: call | ☐ Spreading infection or blistering: urgent review | ☐ Severe illness / collapse: emergency help |
| **Fatigue** | ☐ Usual energy | ☐ Tiredness improves with rest | ☐ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call | ☐ Self-care difficult: urgent review | ☐ Collapse: 112/999 |

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.

# Pembrolizumab every 6 weeks for head and neck cancer

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

Use one record per received cycle or review; keep held doses and symptoms visible.

**Pembrolizumab head and neck · review record 4** · copy this sheet for another cycle of the same phase.

### Pembrolizumab · Immunotherapy

| Symptom | None | Mild | Moderate / call | Severe / urgent | Emergency signs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Breathing / cough** | ☐ Usual breathing | ☐ New cough or breathlessness: call promptly | ☐ Symptoms with usual activity: urgent review | ☐ Breathless at rest: urgent assessment | ☐ Severe breathing difficulty / collapse: 112/999 |
| **Diarrhoea** | ☐ Usual pattern | ☐ Up to 3 extra stools above normal | ☐ 4–6 extra stools/day or at night: call | ☐ 7+ extra stools/day or dehydration: urgent review | ☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999 |
| **Skin / nail changes** | ☐ None | ☐ Mild change: report | ☐ Pain or daily tasks affected: call | ☐ Spreading infection or blistering: urgent review | ☐ Severe illness / collapse: emergency help |
| **Fatigue** | ☐ Usual energy | ☐ Tiredness improves with rest | ☐ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call | ☐ Self-care difficult: urgent review | ☐ Collapse: 112/999 |

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.